

1 Worksheet

Question 1.1. Let $E \in \mathcal{E}$ satisfy $m(E) > 0$. Show that there is a bounded set $A \subseteq E$ such that $m(A) > 0$.

Proof. Consider the increasing collection $\{A_n := (-n, n) \cap E\}_{n=1}^{\infty}$ of measurable sets. By continuity of measure, we have

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} m(A_n) = m\left(\bigcup_{n=1}^{\infty} A_n\right) = m(E) > 0$$

Since the limit of $m(A_n) > 0$, we must have that $m(A_n) > 0$ for at least one n . Hence $A := (-n, n) \cap E \subseteq E$ is a bounded set with $m(A) > 0$. $\square$

Question 1.2. Show that every open set $O \subset \mathbb{R}$ is a countable union of disjoint intervals.

Proof. For each $x \in O$, there is some $\varepsilon > 0$ such that $(x - \varepsilon, x + \varepsilon) \subseteq O$. Note that if $\delta > 0$ is such that for all $0 < \varepsilon < \delta$, $(x - \varepsilon, x + \varepsilon) \subseteq O$, then $(x - \delta, x + \delta) = \bigcup_{0 < \varepsilon < \delta} (x - \varepsilon, x + \varepsilon) \subseteq O$. We thus let $\delta_x = \sup\{\varepsilon > 0 : (x - \varepsilon, x + \varepsilon) \subseteq O\} > 0$, which is finite since $O \neq \mathbb{R}$ and satisfies $U_x := (x - \delta_x, x + \delta_x) \subseteq O$.

By construction of the δ_x 's, we have $\bigcup_{x \in O \cap \mathbb{Q}} U_x$, a countable union of disjoint intervals, is a subset of O . For the reverse equality, for any point $y \in O$, we take $\varepsilon > 0$ for which $(y - 2\varepsilon, y + 2\varepsilon) \subseteq O$, and we take some rational point $x \in (y - \varepsilon, y + \varepsilon) \subseteq O$. Note that then $y \in (x - \varepsilon, x + \varepsilon) \subseteq (y - 2\varepsilon, y + 2\varepsilon) \subseteq O$, so by construction, $y \in (x - \varepsilon, x + \varepsilon) \subseteq U_x$. Therefore, $O \subseteq \bigcup_{x \in O \cap \mathbb{Q}} U_x$, which proves that O is a countable union of disjoint open intervals. $\square$

Question 1.3. Let $E \in \mathcal{E}$ be Lebesgue measurable with $m(E) > 0$. Let $0 < \alpha < 1$. Show that there is a bounded interval I so that

$$m(E \cap I) \geq \alpha m(I)$$

Proof. For any $A \subseteq E$, we have $m(E \cap I) \geq m(A \cap I)$ for any bounded interval I . By question 1, there is a bounded set A with positive measure, so we may assume that E is already bounded. Take $M > 0$ such that $E \subseteq (-M, M)$. By way of contradiction, suppose that $m(E \cap I) < \alpha m(I)$ for all bounded intervals I . For a fixed $\varepsilon > 0$, take open intervals $\{I_k\}_{k=1}^{\infty}$ that cover E and $\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \ell(I_k) < m(E) + \varepsilon$. We then have

$$m(E) \leq \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} m(E \cap I_k) < \alpha \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \ell(I_k) < \alpha m(E) + \alpha \varepsilon$$

Letting $\varepsilon \rightarrow 0$, we see that $m(E) \leq \alpha m(E)$, which is impossible since $m(E) \in (0, \infty)$ (recall that we took E to be bounded) and $\alpha \in (0, 1)$. Therefore, we must have some bounded interval I for which $m(E \cap I) \geq \alpha m(I)$. $\square$

Question 1.4. Let $E \in \mathcal{E}$ be Lebesgue measurable with $m(E) > 0$. Prove that the set $A = E - E := \{x - y : x \in E, y \in E\}$ contains an open interval J such that $0 \in J$.

Proof. By question 3, we take a bounded interval I such that $m(E \cap I) \geq \frac{3}{4}m(I)$. If we suppose that the result does not hold, then we can take a sequence $x_n \rightarrow 0$ such that $x_n \notin E - E$. We take n large enough

such that $|x_n| < \frac{1}{4}m(I)$ and note that $x_n + E \subseteq E^c$. We then get the following:

$$\begin{aligned}
m(I) &= m(E \cap I) + m(I \cap E^c) \\
&\geq m(E \cap I) + m(I \cap (x_n + E)) \\
&= m(E \cap I) + m((I - x_n) \cap E) \\
&\geq 2m(E \cap I) - m(((I + x_n) \setminus (I - x_n)) \cap E) \\
&\geq 2m(E \cap I) - m((I + x_n) \setminus (I - x_n)) \\
&\geq 2m(E \cap I) - 2|x_n| \\
&> \frac{3}{2}m(I) - \frac{1}{2}m(I) \\
&= m(I)
\end{aligned}$$

which is a contradiction. □

Question 1.5. Let $f : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be a Lebesgue measurable function such that

$$f(x + y) = f(x) + f(y)$$

Show that $f(x) = ax$ for some $a \in \mathbb{R}$. **Hint:** Apply Lusin's theorem and the previous problem.

Proof. Use Lusin's theorem to get a closed set F with $m(F^c) < 1/2$ and a continuous $g : F \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ such that $f = g$ on F . By question 1, we can also restrict F to a compact set while keeping $m(F) > 0$. We can then apply question 4 to get an open interval $(-M, M)$ contained in $F - F$. Since F is compact, g is also uniformly continuous on F , so given an $\varepsilon > 0$, there is some $\delta > 0$ for which $|g(x) - g(y)| < \varepsilon$ for any $x, y \in F, |x - y| < \delta$. For any $h \in (-\delta, \delta)$, we take $x \in F$ for which $h = (x + h) - x \in F - F$ and get $f(h) = f(x + h) - f(x) = g(x + h) - g(x) \Rightarrow |f(h)| < \varepsilon$. This shows that f is continuous at 0. For any arbitrary $x_0 \in \mathbb{R}$, we can write $f(x + x_0) = f(x) + f(x_0)$ which shows that f is continuous at x_0 , therefore f is continuous on $\mathbb{R}$. By continuity, it then suffices to only show that $f(x) = ax$ on $x \in \mathbb{Q}$.

Set $a := f(1)$. $f(0) = f(0) + f(0) \Rightarrow f(0) = 0$ and for any $x \in \mathbb{Q}$, we have $f(-x) = f(0) - f(x) = -f(x)$. For any $n \in \mathbb{N}$, we have $f(n) = \sum_{i=1}^n f(1) = an$, and $f(-n) = -f(n) = -an$, so $f(x) = ax$ on $\mathbb{Z}$. For any $n \in \mathbb{N}$, we have $nf(1/n) = f(1) = a \Rightarrow f(1/n) = a/n$ and for any $p, q \in \mathbb{N}$, we have $qf(p/q) = f(p) = ap \Rightarrow f(p/q) = ap/q$, so for any $x \in \mathbb{Q}, f(x) = ax$. As noted earlier, continuity of f shows that $f(x) = ax$ on $\mathbb{R}$. □

Question 1.6. Construct a non-linear $f : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ obeying $f(x + y) = f(x) + f(y)$ for all $x, y \in \mathbb{R}$. (Hint: consider $\mathbb{R}$ as a vector space with scalar field $\mathbb{Q}$)

Proof. Take a basis β for $\mathbb{R}$ as a vector space over $\mathbb{Q}$. This gives us a unique expression of any real number x as $q_1e_1 + \dots + q_ne_n$ for $q_i \in \mathbb{Q} \setminus \{0\}, e_i \in \beta$. This lets us define f by $q_1e_1 + \dots + q_ne_n \mapsto q_1 + \dots + q_n$. This function is obviously additive, but it cannot be continuous on $\mathbb{R}$, since its image is the disconnected set $\mathbb{Q}$. Hence it is not linear. □